

Excel Component Reference Guide

Basic Components

- **Cell**
A cell is the basic unit in an Excel worksheet where users enter data. It is the intersection point of a column and a row.
- **Cell Reference**
This refers to the unique identifier for a cell, combining its column letter and row number (e.g., A1, C5). Columns are labeled alphabetically, and rows are numbered.
- **Active Cell**
The currently selected cell is outlined by a green box. This is where any typed data or formulas will appear.

File & Layout Structure

- **Workbook**
An Excel file that can contain one or more individual worksheets (sheets).
- **Sheet**
A single worksheet within a workbook. Users can switch between sheets using the sheet tabs.
- **Sheet Tab**
Located at the bottom left of the Excel window, these tabs allow users to navigate between different sheets in a workbook.

Navigation Aids

- **Column and Row Headings**
Labels along the top (letters for columns) and left side (numbers for rows) of the worksheet. Clicking a heading selects the entire row or column.
- **Address Bar**
Located to the left of the formula bar, this displays the reference (e.g., B3) of the active cell.

Formulas & Functions

- **Formula**
A mathematical expression, function, or reference to other cells. All formulas must begin with an equals sign = (e.g., =SUM(A1:A5)).
- **Formula Bar**
Found at the top of the worksheet beside the “fx” symbol, this bar is used to view or edit data or formulas in the selected cell.

Helpful Features

- **Filter**

Allows users to selectively display rows based on specific criteria. Found under **Home > Sort & Filter** on the ribbon. Filters can be applied using dropdown arrows on column headers.

- **AutoFill**

This feature automatically fills cells with a series or pattern (e.g., dates, numbers). Click and drag the fill handle (small square at the bottom-right corner of a cell) to apply AutoFill.

- **AutoSum**

A quick way to total values in adjacent cells. Click on a cell below or beside the numbers, then use **Alt + =** or click the **AutoSum** button on the ribbon (**Home > Editing group**).